PACK 541

NEW SCOUT & FAMILY

ORIENTATION

Welcome

PURPOSE

Encourage family fun while providing youth with a **safe space** to make **friends** and **challenge themselves** through age appropriate activities

A place for children and parents to feel like they **belong** to an organization that consistently reinforces worthwhile values like **honesty**, **good conduct**, and **respect** for others

Cub Scouting's values are embedded in the **Scout Oath**, the **Scout Law**, the **Cub Scout motto**, and the Cub Scout sign, handshake, and salute. These practices help establish and reinforce the program's values in Scouts and the leaders who guide them.

Cub Scouting
Aims and Methods

SCOUT OATH, LAW & MOTTO

Scout Oath

On my honor I will do my best
To do my duty To God and my country
and to Obey the Scout Law;
To help other people at all times;
To keep myself physically strong,
mentally awake, and morally straight.

Cub Scout Motto

DO YOUR BEST!

Scout Law

Trustworthy
Loyal
Helpful
Friendly
Courteous
Kind
Obedient
Cheerful
Thrifty
Brave
Clean
Reverent

CUB SCOUTS A BRIEF HISTORY

- **1907** : The Scouting Movement for Boys age 11-18 is started by **Robert Baden-Powell** in the UK
- **1910** : **William D. Boyce** brings Scouting to the United States after being helped in the fog by a young scout in London, he begins establishing the **Boy Scouts of America** (BSA)
- **1914-16** : Baden-Powell began implementing a program for younger boys that is based on Rudyard Kipling's **Jungle Book**. The Wolf Cub program began in 1916 for boys age 8-10
- **1920s-30s** : Cub Scouting is formed in the United States and officially launched in 1930 with over 5000 boys registered, By 1933 Cub Scouting was promoted throughout the country as a part of Scouting.
- **1930s-2000s** : **Cub Scouts** evolves and expands over time allowing younger ages and adding **Tigers**, **Webelos** and **Arrow of Light** ranks
- **2017-2018** : **BSA** expands it's program, allowing **Girls** to join, and **Lion Scouts** for Kindergarteners
- **2025** : **BSA** announces it will change it's name to **Scouting America** in February 2025, taking the Scouting Movement in the USA into a new era!

Scouting America

WORLD SCOUTING

Scouting America is part of the **World Organization of the Scout Movement**

More than 500 million young people and adults have taken part in Scouting since its inception over a century ago. Each joined the Movement to **be active citizens** and **create positive change in their communities**.

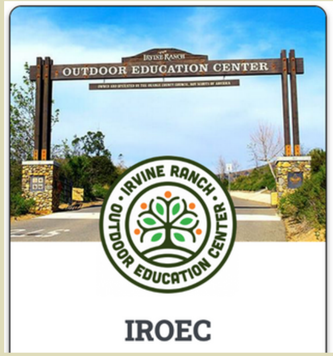
Today, **Scouting is the world's leading educational youth movement** with **over 57 million Scouts in over 200 countries** and territories worldwide. Through its unique combination of **education**, **adventure** and **fun**, Scouting continues to be an inspiration for young people to become active citizens who are **engaged in creating a better and more sustainable world**.

By Joining Cub Scouts your Family is part of much larger global movement

more info at: scout.org

SCOUTING IN ORANGE COUNTY

- Orange County Council Founded in 1921 (ocscoutingamerica.org)
- Serving more than 20,000 youth
- Hosted the National Jamboree in 1953
- Four premier facilities
  - Oso Lake Scout Camp
  - Schoepe Scout Reservation at Lost Valley
  - the Irvine Ranch Outdoor Education Center
  - Newport Sea Base
- Pack 541 was founded in 2001
  - Chartered by The Exchange Club of Irvine
  - part of the Canyons District of OCBSA
    - canyons.ocbsa.org
    - District Executive
      - Shane Backer (shane.backer@scouting.org)



HOW CUB SCOUTING IS ORGANIZED

ORGANIZATIONAL OVERVIEW

Dens

A small group of Cub Scouts who are the same gender and in the same grade. The ideal size is 6 to 8 Cub Scouts.

Den Leaders

An adult, usually a parent, serves as a Den Leader. They carry out the activities related to adventures as they are presented in the Cub Scout's handbook and the Den Leader Guide.

Pack

The pack is made up of several dens. The make up and size of the pack varies based on local interest and resources. Each pack is identified by a number.

Cubmaster

The leader of the pack meeting is the Cubmaster. In addition to serving as the master of ceremonies the Cubmaster provides support to Den Leaders.

Pack Committee

Made up of parents, leaders, and other caring adults the pack committee works to support den leaders and the cubmaster.

Pack Committee Chair

The top volunteer in the pack is the Pack Committee Chair. They are responsible for ensuring enough qualified adult volunteers are in place to provide the program. They lead the pack committee meetings.

Chartered Organization

This is the organization that partners with the Boy Scouts of America to deliver a Scouting program. They adopt Scouting to serve the youth in the community.

Chartered Organization Representative

This person appoints the Pack Committee Chair and approves all adult leaders. They provide resources from the chartered organization.

PACK 541

Boys & Girls

Not Church Affiliated

Inclusive:

- Families of all kinds
- Neurodivergent Scouts
- Accepting of all Faiths/Spirituality

PACK 541 COMMITTEE

Cubmaster	James McMillan
Den Leader – Lion	Joseph Le
Den Leader – Tiger	Chris Brooks
Den Leader – Bear	Russ Peterson
Den Leader – Webelos/AOL	James McMillan
Committee Chair	Tessa Brown
Treasurers	Jenna Ceballos & Michael Bachenheimer
Secretary	Angela McMillan
Advancement Chair	Steph Brooks
New Member Chair	Steph Brooks
Webmaster	Richard McNeley
Training Chair	Jenna Ceballos
Charter Org. Representative	Bill Malecki
Unit Commissioner	Eugene Chen

Current Vacant Positions

Event Coordinators

Program Roles

Den Leader – Wolf

PACK 541

WHAT'S THE TIME COMMITMENT?

- 1 **PACK MEETING** PER MONTH (*1-1.5HRS*)
  - 2ND OR 3RD WEDNESDAY 6:30PM AT PETER'S CANYON MPR
- 1 OR 2 **DEN MEETING**(S) PER MONTH (*1-2HRS*)
  - USUALLY AT A LOCAL PARK, DETERMINED BY DEN
- 2 **WEEKEND CAMPOUTS** (*OCTOBER & APRIL*)
- 3 SAT/SUN EVENTS (*OLYMPICS, DAY OF SERVICE & PINEWOOD DERBY*)

DEN MEETINGS

Frequency: 1-2 times per month
Purpose: Complete rank required and elective adventures
Focus: Character & Leadership, Personal Fitness, Citizenship, Personal Safety, Family & Reverence & **Getting Outdoors!**

THE PARENT'S ROLE

What is an Akela?

An Akela is the scout's adult partner. It can be a father or a mother, but can also be a grandparent, step-parent, older sibling (over 18), or family friend. The Akela attends meetings and helps the scout complete their rank requirements. They check for clarity and understanding of what is learned and support the den leader.

Parent Requirements

- Show up on time if not 10-15mins early
- Attend Den & Pack Meetings with your Scout
- Actively Participate
- Fill a committee, leadership OR volunteer role

Parent Talent Survey

We can only offer as much as we have the hands and support to make it all happen. Our pack's success relies on the time and talent of parents!

ADULT LEADERSHIP/ VOLUNTEER PARTICIPATION

I want to be a leader! What do I need to do??

All leaders need to complete an online BSA Adult Application and Youth Protection Training (YPT). Upon completion of both requirements, notify the Pack Leadership.

Adult Leader Sign-up

You can access the YPT course by visiting my.scouting.org. YPT is good for 2 years, so you will need to retake the course right before your certification expires. Additionally, any parent can be Youth Protection Trained (YPT) even if you don't have an official role and we highly encourage every parent to take YPT if it is possible!

No Cub Scout Pack can run effectively without adult leadership, and Pack 541 is no exception. **Adults are required to plan and run each meeting and event.** The current leadership of Pack 541 is committed to making sure our scouts have a quality program.
EVERY FAMILY IS EXPECTED TO HELP THE PACK IN ONE WAY OR ANOTHER.

Since this is a volunteer run organization, it won't succeed if all participants are not involved.

Remember -- Your scout will get out of this experience what you put into it!!

ADULT LEADERSHIP/ VOLUNTEER PARTICIPATION

Why Volunteer?

The average Scout volunteer gives 10-20 hours of service each month, and 96 percent of volunteers say they would recommend volunteering for the BSA to other adults. In fact, volunteers believe their time invested with Scouting America helps them be:

- A better citizen
- A better parent
- A better manager
- A better employee
- More patient and tolerant of others
- More open to new ideas and opinions

We need you to provide the direction, coaching, and training that empowers today's youth with the skills they will need to lead tomorrow.

The Cub Scout Motto
Also applies to Adult Leaders and Volunteers

DO YOUR BEST!

If Funds are available Pack 541 will cover the Cost of your Adult Membership Fees and assist with Uniform if needed

YOUTH PROTECTION TRAINING

Pack Leadership Requirements

- Background checks
- Finger Printing (State of California Requirement)
- Training
  - Youth Protection Training – every two years
  - Two trained leaders at every event
- Mandated reporters
- Two-deep leadership
  - Adults are never alone with a scout that is not their own child. Adults must always be sure that another adult is with them whether running a meeting or taking a scout to the bathroom on an outing. This is why it is important for parents to attend den meetings!
- Safety policies: Guide to Safety Scouting

Exercises for Parents & Children

- How to Protect Your Children from Child Abuse: A Parent's Guide

ADULT LEADERSHIP/ VOLUNTEER PARTICIPATION RESOURCES

National Cub Scout Program Website

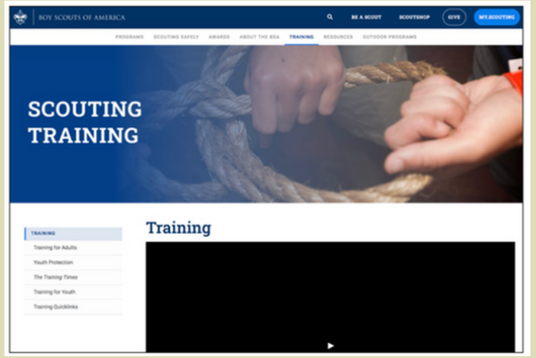
Landing page for all things Cub Scouts including where to find a pack, welcoming new families including a video with the top 5 questions new families ask, and leader resources.

Cub Chat Live

Every Friday at 2 pm Central, Scouting Magazine hosts a live show on Facebook featuring a wide variety of topics and guests. Past shows include how to use Scoutbook, creating effective communication channels, running a Pinewood Derby, tools to get everyone volunteering, and recruiting methods. Shows are 30 minutes and automatically posted to the Cub Chat Live Facebook Playlist after the show. A list of past shows by topic can be found at On Scouting.

Training for Cub Scout Leaders

Cub Scout leader training is available online at any time of the day or night to make needed information easily accessible. Modules are in “bite sized pieces” of 5 to 7 minutes and can be viewed from any smart device or computer. Den leader curriculum is divided into 3 parts: before the first den meeting, first 30 days and 90 days.



SCOUT UNIFORMS

Lion - Kindergarten

T-shirt or Uniform Shirt
Belt
Hat
Optional:
Uniform Shirt
Neckerchief
Neckerchief Slide

Tiger - First Grade

Uniform Shirt
Pants/Shorts
Belt
Hat
Neckerchief
Neckerchief Slide

Wolf - Second Grade

Uniform Shirt
Pants/Shorts
Belt
Hat
Neckerchief
Neckerchief Slide

In Pack 541, we award Scouts their Current Rank's Hat, Neckerchief and Slide once they obtain their Rank's Bobcat Adventure

Helpful Hint: Buy a Uniform Shirts a Size or 2 larger to allow for your Scouts Growth

SCOUT UNIFORMS

Bear - Third Grade

Uniform Shirt
Pants/Shorts
Belt
Hat
Neckerchief
Neckerchief Slide

Webelos - Fourth Grade

Uniform Shirt
Pants/Shorts
Belt
Hat
Neckerchief
Neckerchief Slide
Adventure Colors

Arrow of Light - Fifth Grade

Uniform Shirt
Pants/Shorts
Belt
Adventure Colors
Optional:
Hat
Neckerchief
Neckerchief Slide

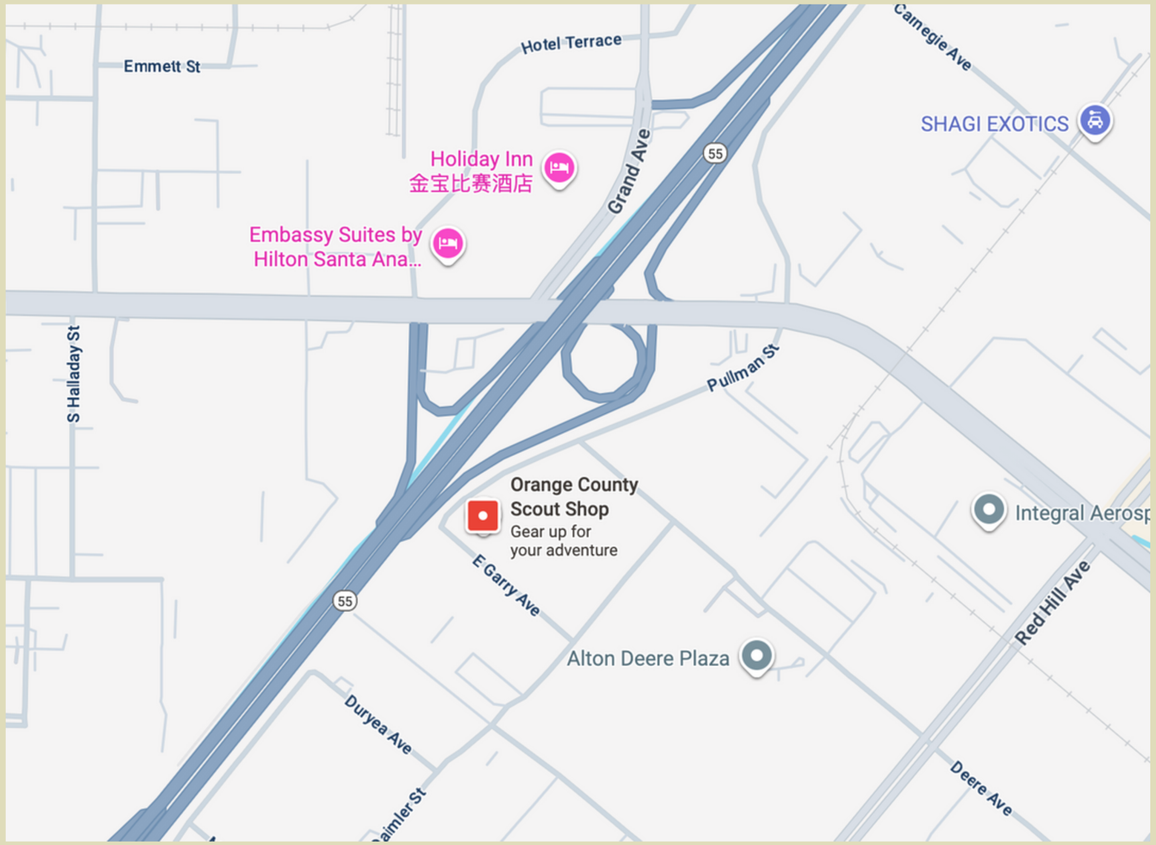
In Pack 541, we award Scouts their Current Rank's Hat, Neckerchief and Slide once they obtain their Rank's Bobcat Adventure

Helpful Hint: Buy a Uniform Shirts a Size or 2 larger to allow for your Scouts Growth

AOL Uniforms will Transition with them to Scouts BSA

PATCH PLACEMENT

PURCHASING UNIFORMS



In Pack 541, we issue new Scouts their Rank's Handbook at the first Pack Meeting to welcome them to the Pack!

Orange County Scout Shop

2953 Pullman Street

Santa Ana, CA 92705

Helpful Hint: *The Scout Shop will sew on patches for a small fee*

Online Official BSA Scout Shop

Uniforms, Gear, Apparel

ADVENTURES & AWARDS

Adventures

- Belt Loops (Lion, Wolf, Tiger, Bear)
- Pins (Webelos, Arrow of Light)

Advancement

- Rank Badges

Special Recognition

- Patches

Cub Scout Adventure Resources Online

ADVENTURES

LION
Kindergarten

REQUIRED ADVENTURES

- **Bobcat** — Character/Leadership
- **Mountain Lion** — Outdoors
- **Fun on the Run** — Personal Fitness
- **King of the Jungle** — Citizenship
- **Lion Roar** — Personal Safety
- **Lion's Pride** — Family/Reverence

TIGER
First Grade

REQUIRED ADVENTURES

- **Bobcat** — Character/Leadership
- **Tigers in the Wild** — Outdoors
- **Tiger Bites** — Personal Fitness
- **Team Tiger** — Citizenship
- **Tiger Roar** — Personal Safety
- **Tiger Circles** — Family/Reverence

WOLF
Second Grade

REQUIRED ADVENTURES

- **Bobcat** — Character/Leadership
- **Paws on the Path** — Outdoors
- **Running with the Pack** — Personal Fitness
- **Council Fire** — Citizenship
- **Safety in Numbers** — Personal Safety
- **Footsteps** — Family/Reverence

BEAR
Third Grade

REQUIRED ADVENTURES

- **Bobcat** — Character/Leadership
- **Bear Habitat** — Outdoors
- **Bear Strong** — Personal Fitness
- **Paws for Action** — Citizenship
- **Standing Tall** — Personal Safety
- **Fellowship** — Family/Reverence

WEBELOS
Fourth Grade

REQUIRED ADVENTURES

- **Bobcat** — Character/Leadership
- **Webelos Walkabout** — Outdoors
- **Stronger, Faster, Higher** — Personal Fitness
- **My Community** — Citizenship
- **My Safety** — Personal Safety
- **My Family** — Family/Reverence

ARROW OF LIGHT
Fifth Grade

REQUIRED ADVENTURES

- **Bobcat** — Character/Leadership
- **Outdoor Adventurer** — Outdoors
- **Personal Fitness** — Personal Fitness
- **Citizenship** — Citizenship
- **First Aid** — Personal Safety
- **Duty to God** — Family/Reverence

FEES

Program & Admin Costs

$160 National & Council Dues

$15 Scout Life Subscription *(optional)*

- paid directly to BSA at account creation through my.scouting.org

$250 Pack 541 Dues*

- Pack 541 dues paid directly to Treasurer via Venmo or Check by your first Pack Meeting
- @Pack-Treasurer-541
- Based on a 10 month program. Fees may be prorated based on the time your Scout's application is accepted.
- Pack T-shirt
- Covers the cost of handbooks, hats, neckerchiefs, and neckerchief slides once completing a rank at the end of the program year at Crossover/Bridging event.
- Activities, Materials, Operational & Administrative Cost of the Pack.

venmo

***Special Events**

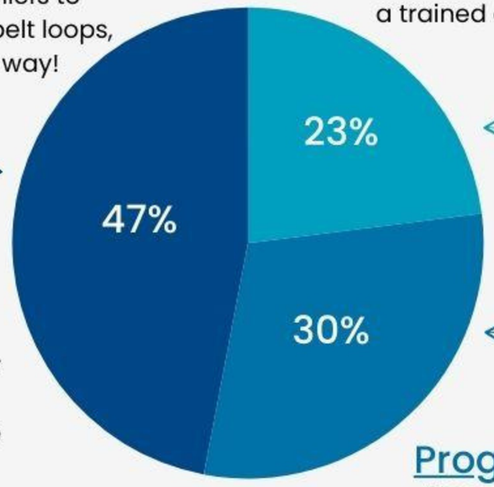
- Additional fees for Campout meals & Special Events/Activities
- Council-hosted Events fees paid through scoutingevent.com

FEES

Pack 541 Dues: $250

Scout Awards
From handbooks and neckerchiefs to Adventure pins, patches, and belt loops, we celebrate every step of the way!

Leader Training & Support
We cover fees and trainings for our volunteers because every Scout deserves a trained and prepared leader.



Program Year
September-May with summer activities that fuel adventure, growth, and leadership for the entire family.

Programs & Events
Dues also fund supplies for meetings and awesome events like Pinewood Derby, Campouts, and more!

Fundraising
Our goal is to raise $2,000, which helps offset membership dues.

venmo

Special Events

- Additional fees for Campout meals & Special Events/Activities
- Council-hosted Events fees paid through scoutingevents.org

ANNUAL HEALTH AND MEDICAL RECORDS

All participants in all Scouting activities must complete Part A and Part B.
Give the completed forms to your unit leader. This applies to all activities, day camps, local tours, and weekend camping trips. These forms are updated at least annually.

You can fill out and print the form to turn in at an upcoming Pack meeting or fill out and send a PDF to admin@pack541.org

Part A is an informed consent, release agreement, and authorization that needs to be signed by every participant (or a parent and/or legal guardian for all youth under 18).
Part B is general information and a health history.

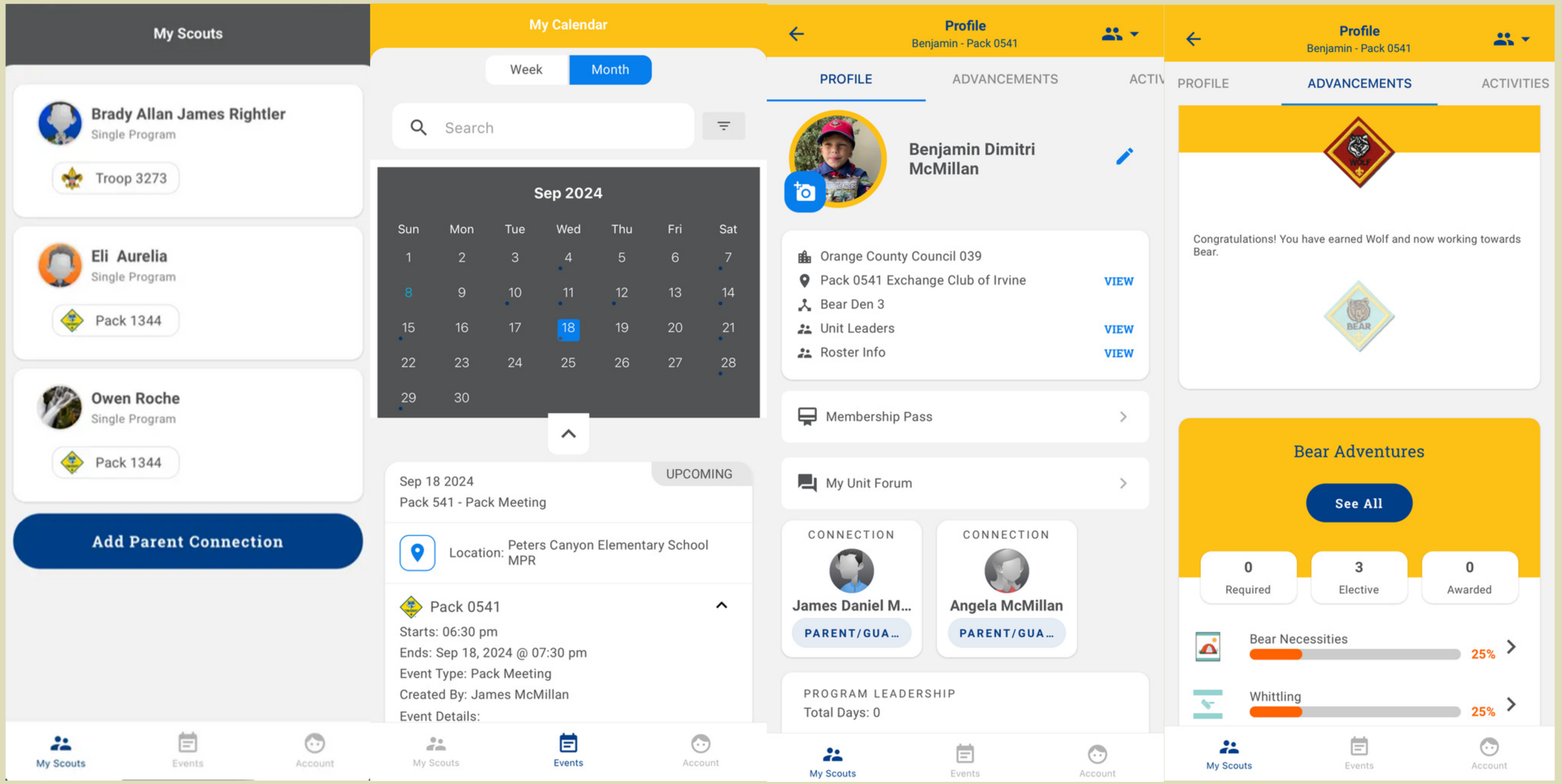
Updated Medical A & B Forms are due at the beginning of each new programming year for the Pack to keep on file for events, if one is not on file you will be requested to fill out the forms before participating in the Event.

download and fill out the form here

SCOUTING APP

IOS App Store

Google Play Store



The **Scouting App** makes it easier than ever for youth and their parents to view and **track advancement in the Cub Scouting programs**. The app pulls existing advancement data straight from **Scoutbook** for viewing on an enhanced user interface.

Parents should use their **Scoutbook** credentials to login. If you don't have a Scoutbook account yet, visit **scoutbook.scouting.org** to create one.
If a parent doesn't see their Scout, contact Pack Leadership and ask that you are Linked with your child in **Scoutbook**.

PACK COMMUNICATIONS

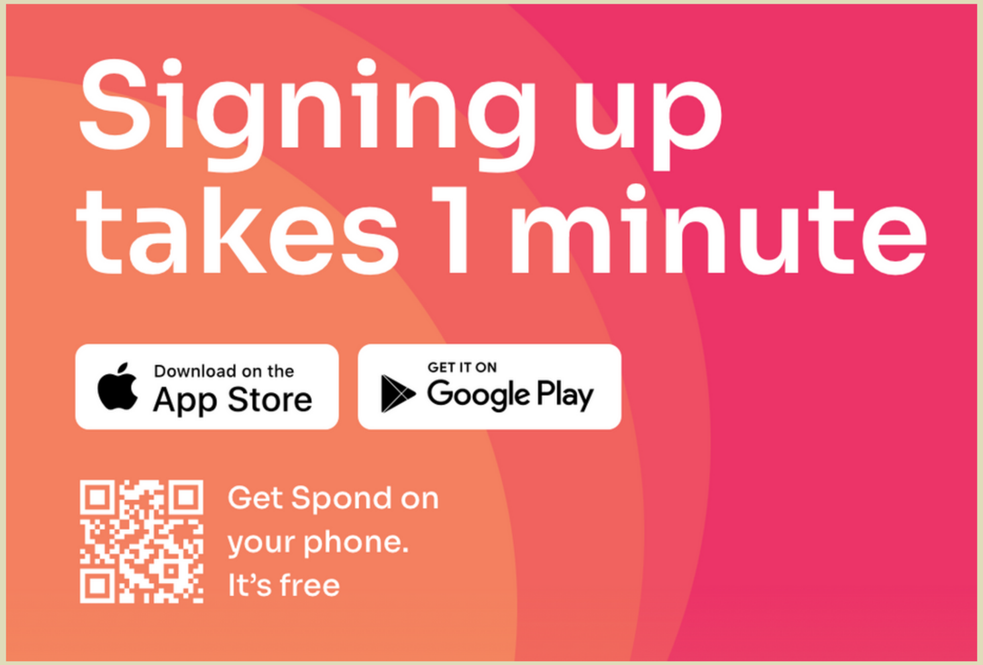
Pack 541 Primarily communicates with Parents and their Scouts via the Spond Mobile App for all pack communications, event updates, and our calendar.

Group ID: LTURZ

You'll receive an invite soon – **please download the app and enable notifications** so you never miss the fun! This is your lifeline to all things Pack 541.

If you aren't receiving proper communications from the Pack or your scout's Den Leader please contact Pack Leadership ASAP at info@pack541.org

Spond



2025-26 MEETINGS/EVENTS

Pack Meetings

Location: Peters Canyon
Elementary MPR
6:30 PM -7:30 PM

September 17, 2025
October 15, 2025
November 12, 2025
December 10, 2025
January 14, 2026
February 18, 2026
March 11, 2026
April 15, 2026
May 20, 2026

Pack Events

September 27, 2025 - Pack Olympics (*at Fall Camput*)
November 1, 2025 - Day of Service
January 24, 2026 - Pinewood Derby
February 18, 2026 - Blue & Gold Banquet

Family Campouts

September 26th-28th, 2025
Caspers Wilderness Park

April 24th-26th, 2026
O'Neil Regional Park

WHAT'S NEXT?

- If you haven't Signed up your Scout already you can do so here
- Once you have signed-up!
  - **Fill out the Parent Talent Form** to see how you can best contribute to the Pack
  - **Complete the Medical A/B Form** for both you and your scout and print to bring to your first Pack Meeting or email a pdf to membership@pack541.org
  - **Purchase your Scout's Uniform Shirt** from the Scout Shop or on scoutshop.org
  - **Send your Venmo account info to treasurer@pack541.org** for invoicing of pack dues or friend request on Venmo (@pack-treasurer-541)
- Your Scout's Den Leader should be getting in contact with you when Den Meetings are scheduled
- **Be on the look out to link your scouting.org account with your Scout's in Scoutbook** (*check your spam folder*) If you have any issues please contact us at info@pack541.org
- BSA will be sending you emails periodically with more information on cub scouting
- **If you ever need anything or have questions please email the pack leadership at admin@pack541.org**

Sign-up and Register on beascout.org

Parent Talent Survey

BSA Medical A/B Form

Venmo: @pack-treasure-541

pack website: pack541.org

Q&A

We've unloaded a lot of information on you, so please feel free ask any questions you may have

NEW SCOUT & FAMILY

ORIENTATION

THANK YOU!